COLLABORATIVE
Research
METHODS
Should
YOU
KNOW

People-Centered Design Research
Fall 2015

INTRODUCTION

Collaborative *Research* **Methods** **You** *Should* **Know** is a helpful guide to essential people-centered design methods. This book is compiled from first-hand experience with the outlined methods to assist others in their application of design research. The methods in the chapters are separated into four main categories that correspond to their use in design research. The first chapter encompasses **Exploratory** methods; these methods focus on the study of what currently exists. The second part of the book are **Envisioning** methods, these allow researchers to expand possibilities and think of what could be. **Sensemaking** methods, the third chapter, allow you and others to understand and synthesize information to assist in creating informed decisions from the data collected. The final chapter are **Evaluative** methods, which include processes for shaping decisions.

Use this guide to provide yourself the tools necessary to conduct research using collaborative methods to find the most appropriate solutions.

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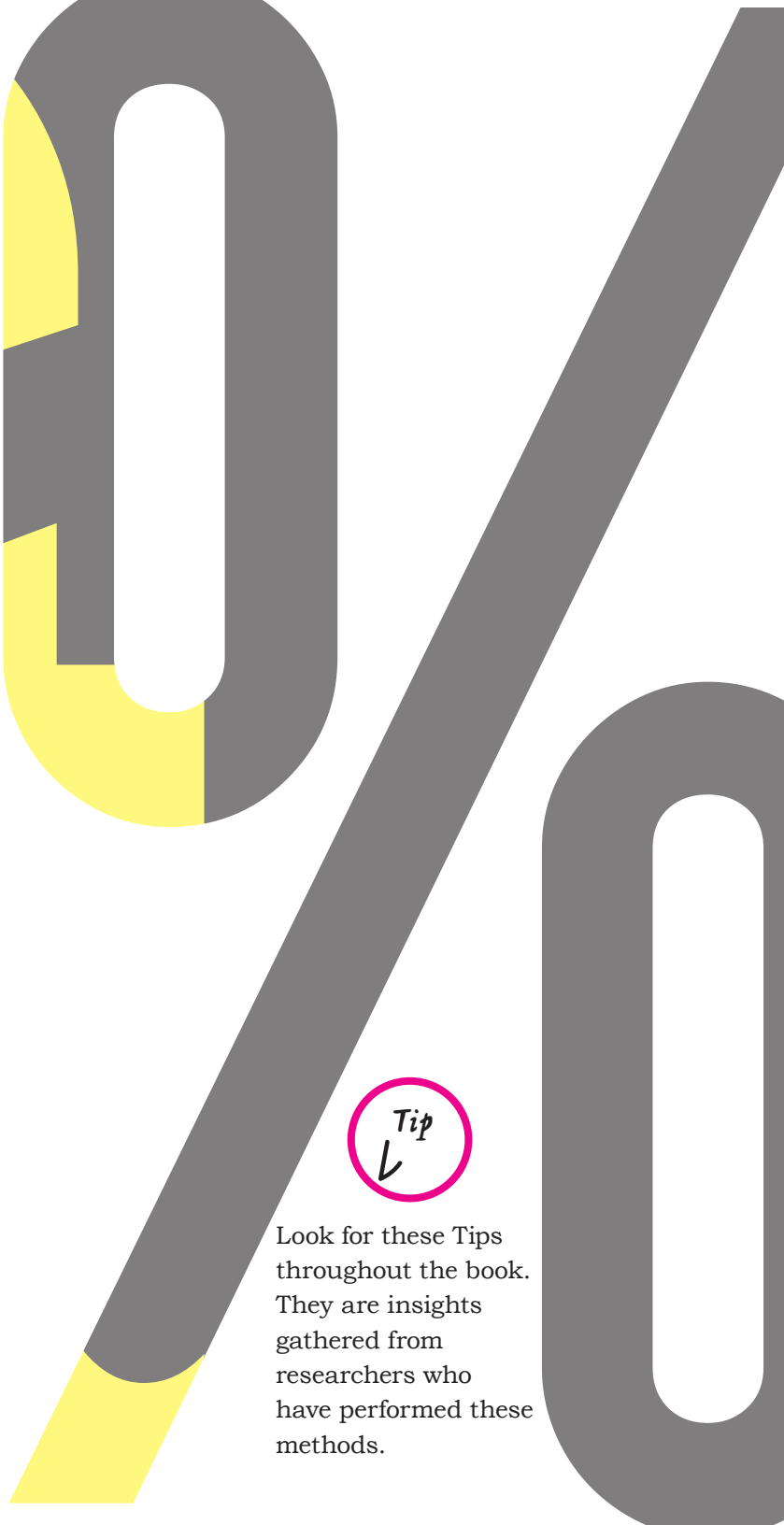


Tip

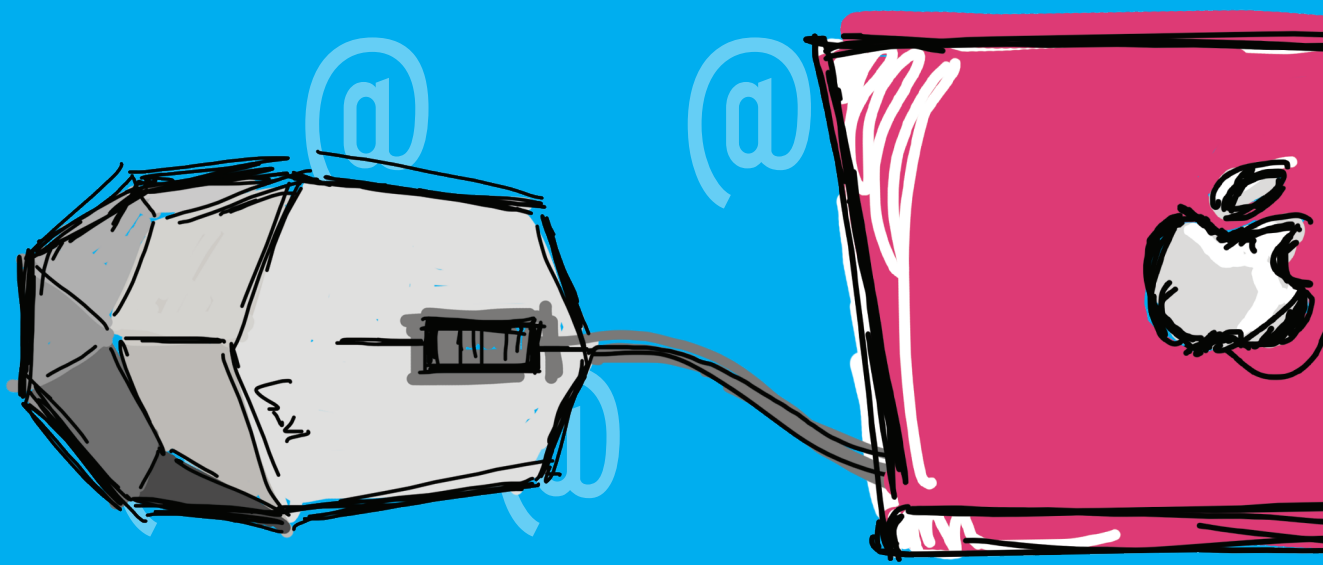
Look for these Tips throughout the book. They are insights gathered from researchers who have performed these methods.

EXPLORATORY

What is?

Exploratory methods utilize diverging techniques to examine what is existing.

At {Exploratory}
We see what is currently there (AT) in what we are researching. "What is, or who is…"



INTERVIEW

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Exploratory

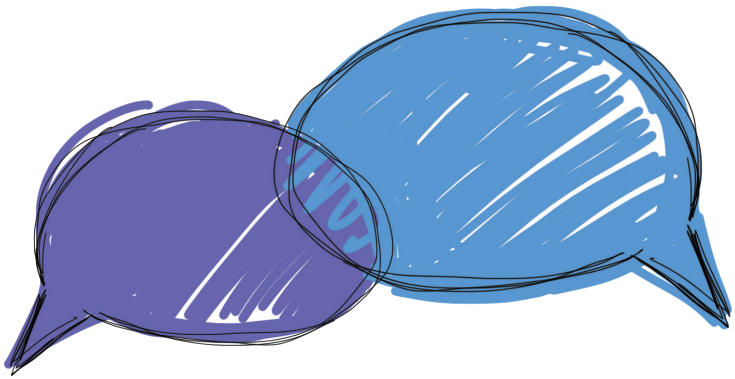
OBJECTIVE:
Interviews are conversations with the intent of getting more information or details about a specific person or subject. It could be beneficial to engage your participant within their own environment because it could inform the interview process or fill in gaps left in the conversation. An interview can also allow a researcher to gain insight from a participant who is an expert in the area of interest. The participant will have a thorough understanding of their own experience with the area of interest.

MATERIALS:
- Question script or guide
- Pen/pencil/paper for notes
- Recording device

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Subject/ Present

ACTIVITIES:
1. Prepare questions prior to the interview session. Background research is helpful in order to craft appropriate questions for the session.
2. Begin a dialogue with participant. Structure the conversation in a way that allows for insightful information. Remember to always ask for permission before recording if you choose to document this way.

   Tip
3. Be ready to follow the flow of the conversation. Sometimes a change in direction can reveal new information. Strictly going through a list of questions might not help you achieve this.

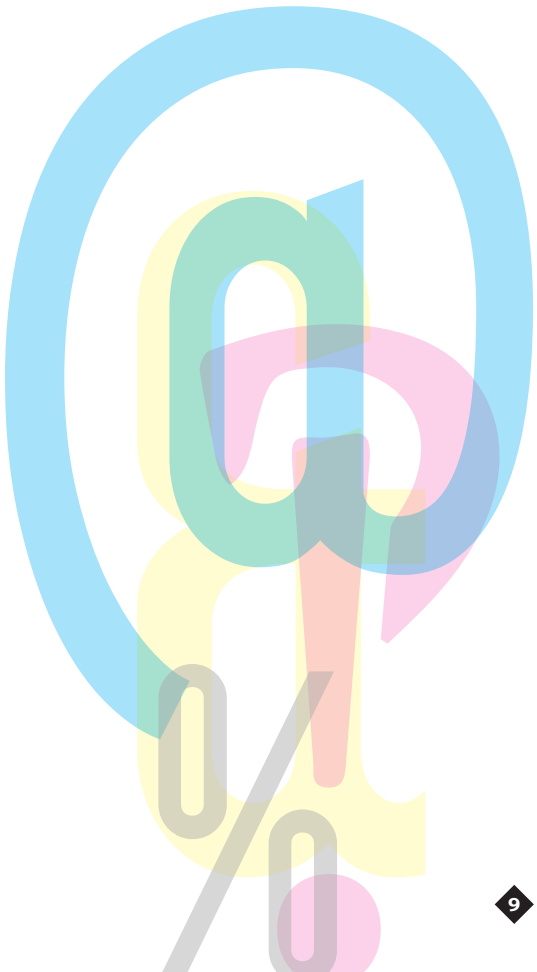


BENEFITS:

In-person interviews allows the researcher to observe the nuances of body language.

CHALLENGES:

1. Establishing rapport with your subject.
2. Knowing when to keep quiet in order to let the participant gather their thoughts.
3. Letting the conversation flow can reveal new things, but might leave certain key points without being covered.
4. Balancing note-taking and asking questions.
5. Starting the communication.
6. Appropriate body language.
7. Time control.



INTERVIEW VARIATIONS

"HUMANS OF NEW YORK" INTERVIEW

ACTIVITIES:
These activities can help drive the interview and are based on techniques developed by photographer, Brandon Stanton.

- Take the participant's picture before beginning the interview.
- Ask the participant broad questions diving into the participant's emotional memories.
- Narrow in your questions based on their responses.

MATERIALS:
The materials needed include: any type of camera, pen and paper, an a list of broad "starter" questions, but anticipate the need to be flexible during the interview.

CHALLENGES:
Not having an outline of questions can make it difficult to adjust and draw out responses. The researcher may need to practice this technique before-hand and be ready to be flexible and adaptable to the participants' responses.

SKYPE INTERVIEW

BENEFITS:

Skype interviews are conversation with the intent of getting more information or details about a specific person or subject. It could be beneficial to engage your participant within their own environment because it could inform the interview process or fill in gaps left in the conversation. For an interview, deeper answers might be more valuable than a large quantity of answers. The idea is to get to significant bits of information. And instead of having a conversation face to face, you will talk with your participant through Skype.

MATERIALS:

A computer, Skype, pen and paper, a list of questions, tool to take notes.

PHONE INTERVIEW

BENEFITS:

Conversations in a phone interview are often held over communication channels that do not require the subject to not be present in the same place as the interviewer.

CHALLENGES:

Learning to give your participants plenty of pause between questions is a valuable aspect to an interview that does not take place in person. Unlike with a standard interview a person can not indicate when they have given their complete answer through body language and other methods that can be picked up on. To accommodate this it is important to allow a person to fully articulate their thought and give a few seconds between your questions to ensure that you do not interrupt the participant.

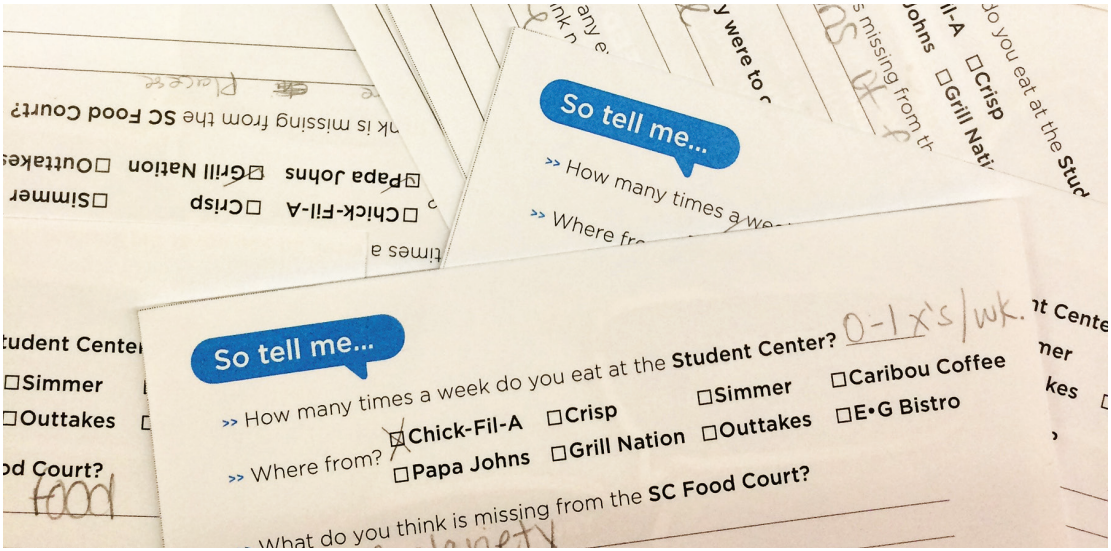
@ INTERCEPT QUESTIONNAIRE

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Exploratory

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Subject / Present

OBJECTIVE:
This opportunistic method is used to gather quick responses from an audience regarding a specific subject area. These questionnaires or surveys are typically brief and can be answered quickly, usually conducted in areas where various respondents are available. Once answers are gathered and interpreted, they could reveal specific trends, desires or an inclination from the participating group. Depending on the size of the sample, these answers could present significant insights.

ACTIVITIES:
1. Design questions related to desired subject area.
2. Engage with users to get as many replies as possible to the questionnaire. Choosing the correct place and way to approach participants is key to success.
3. If helpful, provide users a small incentive to participate. Also a good way to get users to participate.



MATERIALS:

- Question sheets
- Pen or pencil for answers
- Incentive

BENEFITS:

1. Can grab participants and get brief responses. The time invested will depend on the quantity of participants desired.
2. Can be used to uncover some trends or insights that can later be explored in more detail via other methods.

CHALLENGES:

1. Getting participants to answer questions
2. Crafting questions that could be answered quickly but insightfully
3. Getting credible answers from participants. Some might not take it so seriously.

@ PARTICIPANT OBSERVATION

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Exploratory

OBJECTIVE:
To conduct research by immersing yourself into an environment or particular subject. By doing so the researcher can gain an empathetic understanding of a desired area using first hand experience. There are many ways of conducting participant observation depending on the defined area of focus. Doing preliminary research on the area prior to immersion may be helpful.

Tip

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Subject / Present

ACTIVITIES:
Select an area of observation and fully submerse yourself in that area. As a participant, actively engage in the activity to gain personal experience. Record observations and insights throughout the process. Be sure to leave time for reflection each day while the information is still fresh in your mind. Illustrating your observations is another way to record data.
While immersed in the area, the researcher can interview the people in that environment.

Tip

MATERIALS:
The materials needed will depend upon the chosen area. Recording devices will be very important such as video or audio. A daily journal could be useful depending on the length of time of the immersion process.

BENEFITS:

Interaction with people from the area of interest has its own special benefits such as:

1. Deepen your understanding of your particular topic
2. Earn trust from the people in that environment
3. Understand the values and systematic processes of the users

CHALLENGES:

Be mindful of how you immerse yourself. If your participation allows for distraction from gaining insight, it may be best to try fly-on-the wall observation where you observe as a bystander and not as an active participant.

Being immersed in an environment can produce an overwhelming amount of data.

VARIATIONS:

Fly-on-the Wall

To observe a subject or environment in its natural state while causing as little disruption as possible.

Activities

1. Select area or subject of interest
2. Position self in a way to blend in with natural environment
3. Record observations using words, sketches, and pictures
4. Activate all senses while observing

Tip

VISUAL STORYBOARD INTERVIEW

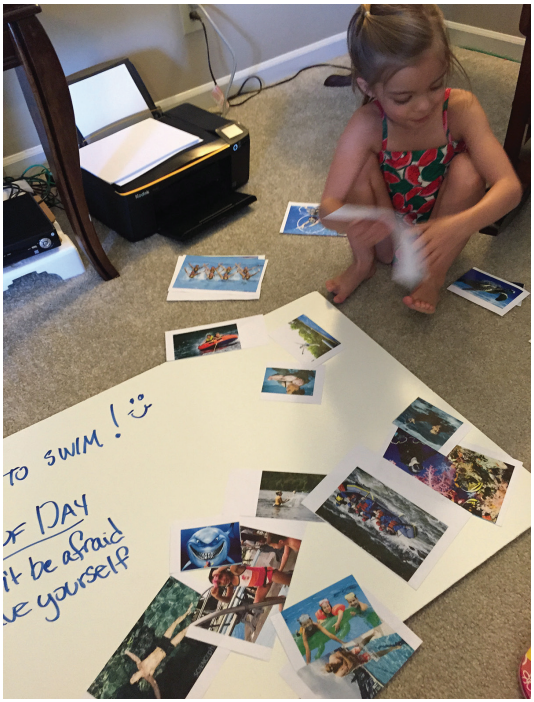
MODE OF INQUIRY:
Exploratory

OBJECTIVE:
The objective should be to discover what currently exists in a problem space through the use of pictures and visuals.

MATERIALS:
The materials needed include: white board, markers, inventory of 40+ images, and tape to tape pictures to the white board.

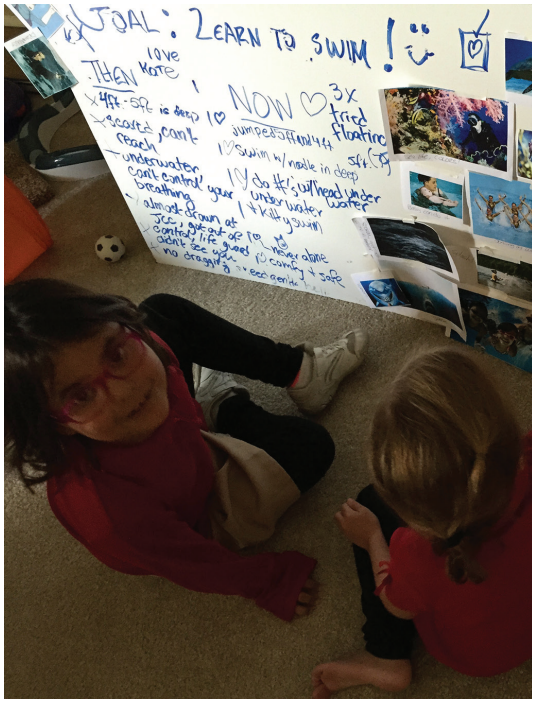
MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

ACTIVITIES:
Create a library of printed images relating to the problem space. As questions are asked, have participant select images. Ultimately this will give the researcher a better understanding of the problem. . Essentially this is an interview with visual cues to help the participant verbalize the current state of the problem.



BENEFITS:
This method is great for participants that have a more difficult time verbalizing their thoughts and feelings. The visuals can also help stimulate ideas, and make sure that the researcher is understanding exactly what the participant describes.

CHALLENGES:
The main challenge of this method is that sometimes the pictures do not reflect the participant's opinions. Ideally, the participant should help create or add to the library to overcome this.



ENVISIONING

What could be?

Envisioning methods utilize diverging techniques to imagine future possibilities. Quantity is valued in this category

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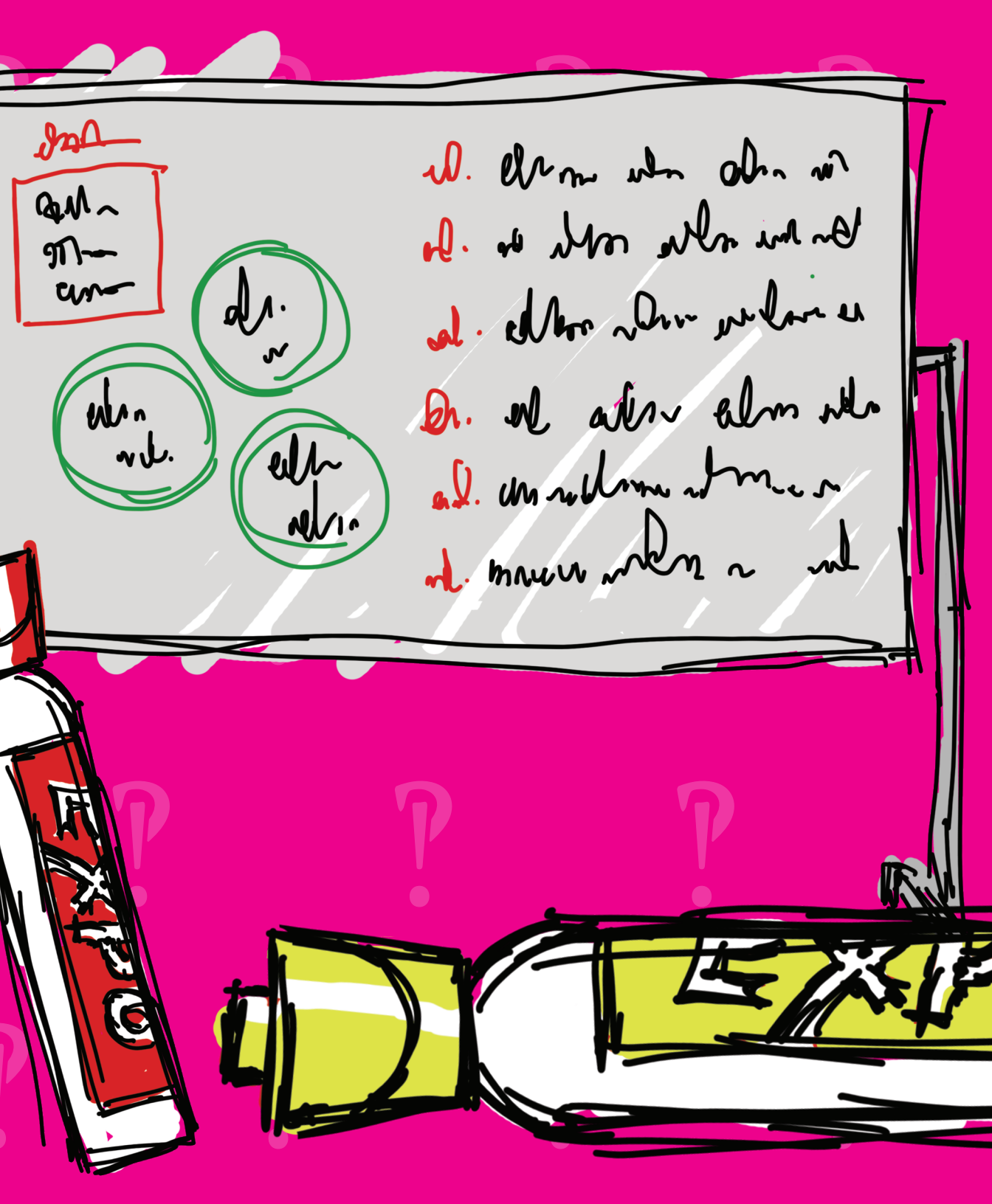
Interrobang {Envisioning}
We question the possibilties of what could be. “Could this work if we combine…”



BRAINSTORMING

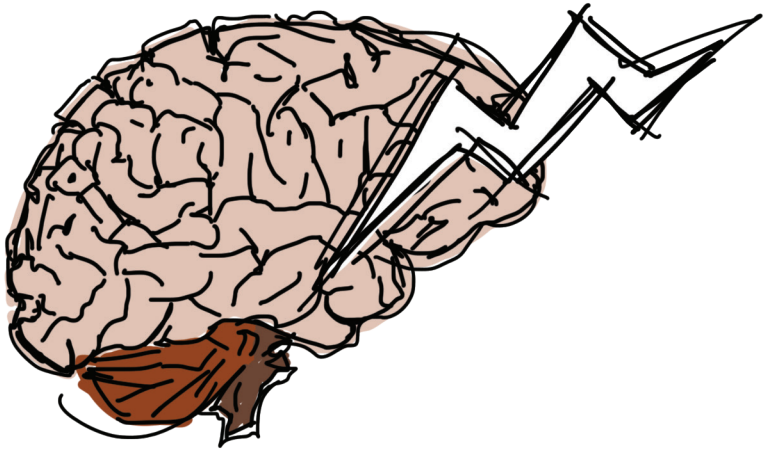
MODE OF INQUIRY:
Envisioning

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
This method can be used to generate ideas, and share thoughts aloud with many participants and works best with a large group of participants. It is always important to keep the flow of ideas going. The point is to generate as many ideas as possible.

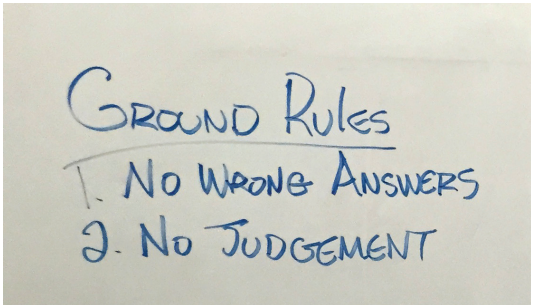
ACTIVITIES:
The researcher should go over the ground rules with participants, assign a note taker, provide a challenge, gather insights on a white board or easily viewed platform. The ideas could be recorded by writing, drawing or any method that facilitates the brainstorm. The researcher structures the exact activity.

MATERIALS:
- White board
- Marker
- Prompts or challenge to work with.



BENEFITS:

1. Gathering many ideas quickly and efficiently during a given time frame.
2. It can help stimulate conversation and flow of ideas.
3. Improved the way of communication.
4. Recieve various insights from various people.
5. Unexpected answers that could help to improvise new type of questions to ask.



CHALLENGES:

Watch out here for "ouch phrases" from the participants. Participants may revert to their usual way of thinking by jumping to evaluating ideas during the brainstorm. This should be avoided and made clear in the ground rules. Also the researcher as the facilitators should be aware of their own contributions to the brainstorm and avoid steering the participants.

BRAINSTORMING

BRAINSTORMING WITH ILLUSTRATIONS

ACTIVITIES:

Give a prompt and allow participants to draw together on white board. Facilitate illustrations by encouraging wild ideas. Be sure to set ground rules to discourage killer phrases and converging. Encourage participants who may not feel comfortable drawing to use "stick figures" and include captions if necessary.

MATERIALS:

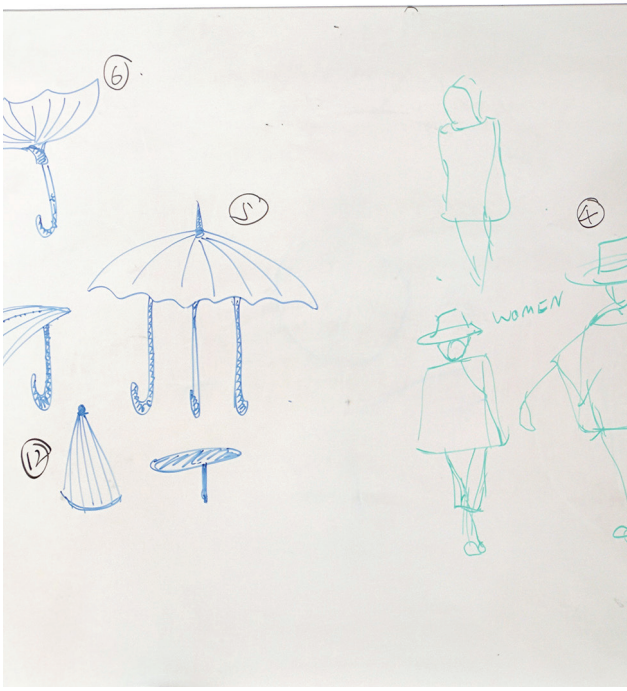
- Brainstorming prompt
- White board
- Markers

CHALLENGES:

Not every one is comfortable with drawing so it is important to emphasize that there is not judgment with ability to draw and that even simple drawings are okay.

CHALLENGES:

- Allows participants to use their imagination.
- Encourages a fun environment.
- Promotes creativity which helps with creative thinking.
- Gain insight by viewing all of the images together as one collective piece.



Free gym
Free swimming Pool
FREE
Water
Water
Organic Food
Market

redisgn
umbrellas.
JACK
Function:
to open
close
Dimension

CARD SORTING

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Envisioning

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
Activity used to envision possible components (in this case a toolkit). Can be helpful to visualize components of a future product or system as a dynamic process. Allows the flexibility to add on or take off elements during the envisioning process.

ACTIVITIES:

1. The participant is given a set of cards with images on them to see if they could put them together in order to envision the possible content for a toolkit. In addition to the image cards, blank cards can be distributed with a marker to fill in any holes left from the visuals provided.
2. After reviewing the card set given, the participant organizes them in clusters to best fit the toolkit being assembled. Positive and negative associations can be the main framework, then categorical groups can be used as secondary.
3. It is helpful for the participant to voice thoughts associated with the cards and the reasons behind the pairings.
4. After the participant has organized them, she can write out the missing content and place them into the corresponding groups.

MATERIALS:

- Cards with images
- Blank cards
- Marker
- Camera for documentation

BENEFITS:

1. Flexibility to add on, take away and modify for the desired final result.
2. Can be done individually or in a group setting depending on the goal/objective of the method.

CHALLENGES:

1. Choosing the correct images to have present in the options.
2. Trying not to guide the participants as much as possible so that they can create on their own terms.

PROBING FOR THE FUTURE

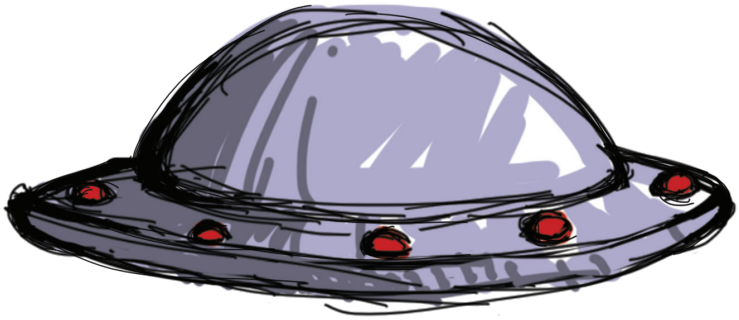
MODE OF INQUIRY:
Envisioning

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
The researcher can use this method when they need a participant to generate ideas from a given prompt.

MATERIALS:
Materials include a blank sheet of paper with the prompt and colored pens, markers, or any other writing materials of your choice.

ACTIVITIES:
The researcher should give the participant a blank sheet with a prompt and writing utensils. The futuristic prompt should probe for suggestions and new ideas with minimal guidance from others or from the researcher.

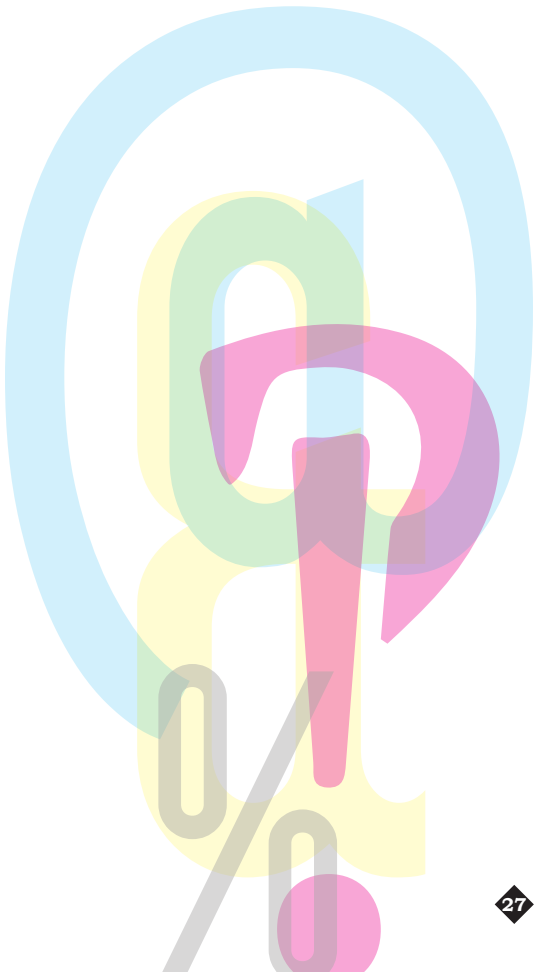


BENEFITS:

This method can help participants who are more reserved still share their ideas in a more private and secure way. Having the prompt be futuristic will also encourage participants to think of any ideas, regardless of whether or not it is possible right now.

CHALLENGES:

The challenge of this method is that sometimes the participants need more guidance and become frustrated by the ambiguity of the prompt. They may also mis-interpret your prompt or think of ideas that may be considered unrelated to your design challenge. Depending on how much you tell the participant, this can be adjusted.



PROTOTYPING

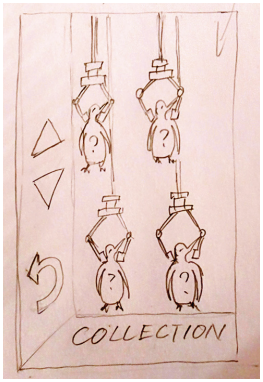
MODE OF INQUIRY:
Envisioning

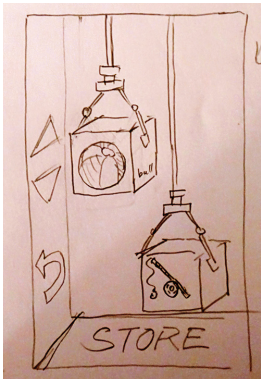
MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
Prototyping is a way to create a low cost version of a product or concept and demonstrate how that could look. The fidelity of a prototype can vary, based on the situation and the audience that will see the prototype. By creating a prototype the weakness of a product can be seen early on and modified based on new input.

ACTIVITIES:
1. Sketching, wire framing, building of proposed product to understand functionality.
2. Critique of proposed product or concept from prospective users to understand the usability and see possible improvements.

MATERIALS:
Construction of a prototype can be as simple as using paper & pen, construction paper & glue, or any available materials to show the general idea of the product in mind. If there is more time and Illustrator is available, it can be used to create a higher fidelity prototype.





BENEFITS:
By starting with low fidelity prototypes, project can be analyzed quickly to test the viability of the product as well as the usability. Prototyping can be while envisioning new ideas, but it can also be used to better understand or evaluate ideas based on the objective.

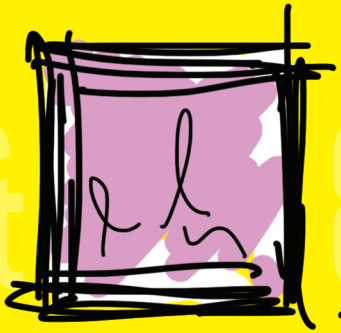
CHALLENGES:
Understanding which media to use to best represent the product could be one of the main challenges to creating a prototype. Even though you may use a low fidelity prototype, the objective is to prove a concept and present that concept to the desired audience.

SENSEMAKING

Shaping understanding

Sensemaking methods utilize converging techniques to allow for understanding and information synthesis.

& **Ampersand {Sensemaking}**
How one piece of data relates to another. “This AND this relate because…”

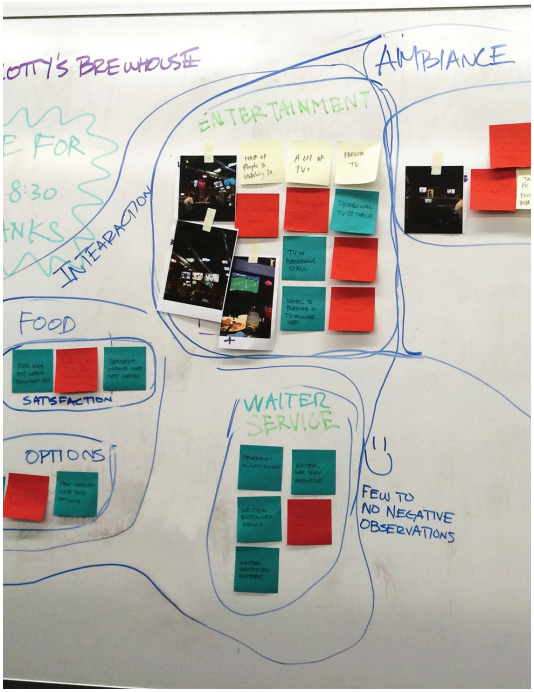


AFFINITY MAPPING

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
After gathering data through an Exploratory method, Affinity Mapping can help understand how the data relates to each other and if there are any trends or relations that can be extracted from the collected information.



ACTIVITIES:

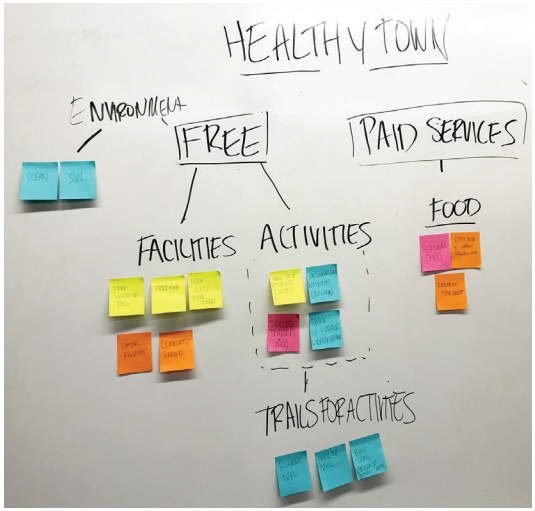
1. Collect the data or information that will be later grouped.
2. Write the data out on Sticky Notes that will allow for moving them around groups depending on the associations found.
3. Do an overall look at the gathered data and begin sorting into groups that relate the data points well.
4. Keep going through this process until a suitable clustering is reached. This can take many tries because in seeing the information together at once, one can begin to understand.

Tip

5. Label the major cluster groups.
6. Be patient, Sensemaking takes time.

MATERIALS:

- Marker
- Sticky Notes
- White board with markers
- Time!



CHALLENGES:

1. Group vs individual. While working individually can be easier, working in groups will give richer insights.
2. Correct category names are important. They should be intentional.

BENEFITS:

1. Understand the entire landscape of an exploration and see what patterns emerge.
2. Working collaboratively on this method can enrich the process and benefit the clustering process by bringing different perspectives.

CONCEPT MAPPING

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

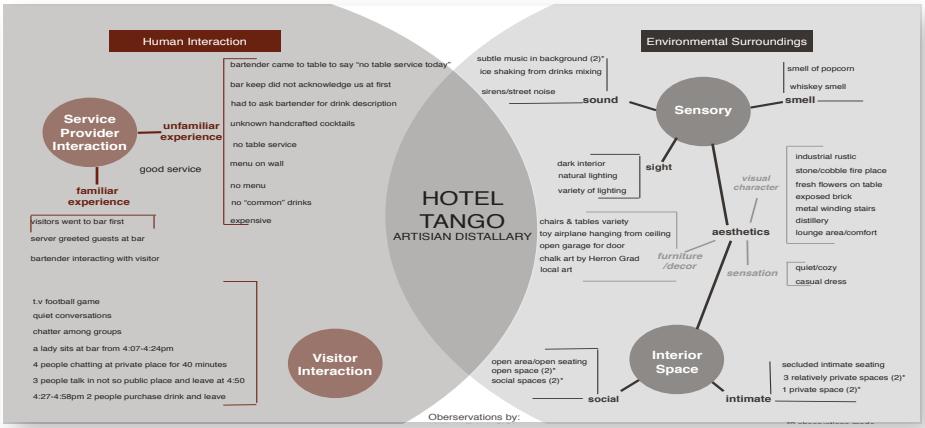
MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

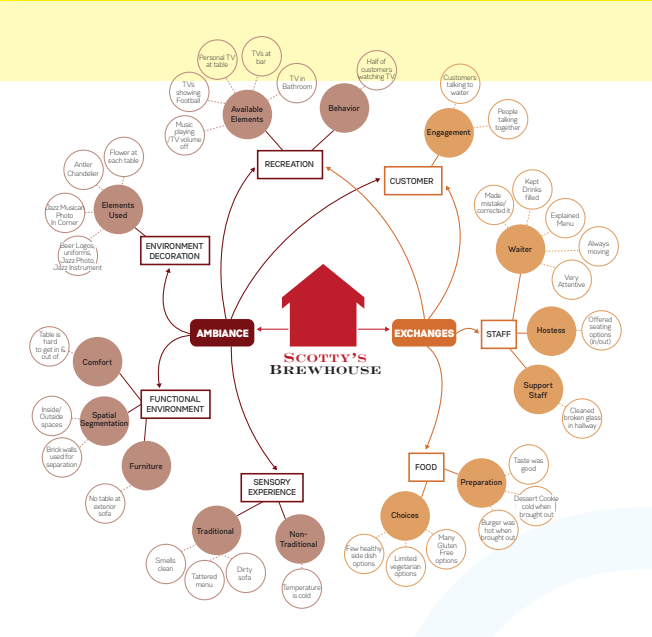
OBJECTIVE:
To visualize relationships among a large amount of data. Concept maps create a visual hierarchy among concepts allowing for a viewers to gain a deeper understanding. It also allows for the development of insights from complex information.

ACTIVITIES:
After collecting data by using exploratory or envisioning methods, you'll want to begin analyzing the data. Transferring insightful data on sticky notes could be a good first step. Next you may want to use affinity diagramming in order to group your information according to a category. Once you have well defined groups of information you can begin creating concept maps based upon a visual of a clear hierarchy of concepts. The main category will be the most important with sub categories branching from there.

MATERIALS:

- Previously gathered data
- Sticky notes
- Sharpie marker
- White board and markers (if developing with participants)
- Digital software (if composing a final deliverable piece)





BENEFITS:

1. Organize large amount of data clearly for viewers
2. Exemplify a visual hierarchy among relationships
3. Communicate insight using visual nuances

CHALLENGES:

Deciding the correct word to use as the dominant concept can be difficult. Brainstorm synonyms or similar words to confirm you have the most appropriate choice.

INVENTORY INSIGHT MAPPING

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
After going through an inventory, Insight Mapping can help understand underlying trends and overlaps in the materials being observed. Seeing what is available and understanding the trends allows for more informed suggestions or solutions. This can be considered a combination of an Exploratory method that generates the data which is later processed through a Sensemaking angle to understand what is there and how it relates.

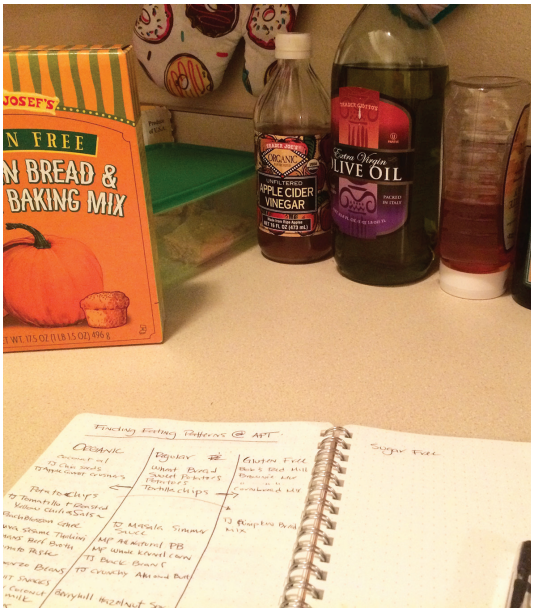
ACTIVITIES:

1. Gather data to be analyzed by observing, taking inventory or any other method conducive for this. If performing an inventory observation, a table or matrix might be a convenient way to gather the information. It allows the researcher to write down the name and any categories that pertain to the product. This way overlaps can be seen as you go.
2. Go over list of gathered materials and begin to see if any trends start to show.
3. Identify possible areas of overlap and develop a visual model that lets you gather the information in a way that is easy to understand and grasp.

Tip

MATERIALS:

- Marker
- Sticky Notes
- White board with markers
- Time!

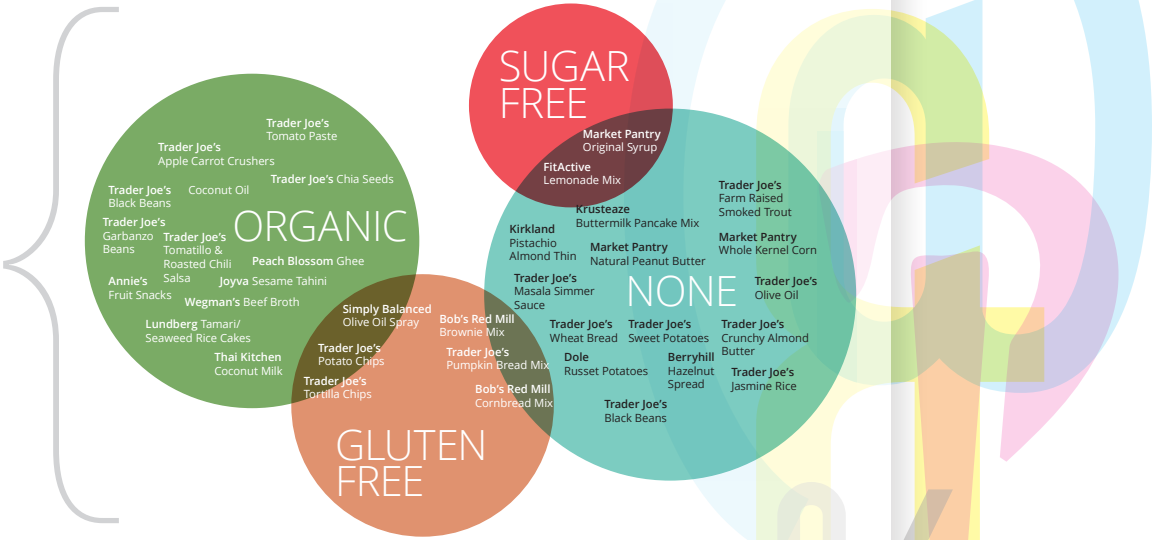


BENEFITS:

1. Understand the entire landscape of an exploration and see what patterns emerge.
2. Working collaboratively on this method can enrich the process and benefit the clustering process by bringing different perspectives.

CHALLENGES:

If the inventory is too varied it might not reveal too many insights worth pointing out in a visualization. Maybe that could be considered an insight?



THE GOOGLE DOC METHOD

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Not Present

OBJECTIVE:
This method can be used if not all of the participants can meet in person, and should be used to help make sense of your data.

ACTIVITIES:
First collect data to make sense of, connect all of the participants to the Google Doc (each participant will need a Gmail Account), connect all of the participants on a shared phone conference, explain sensemaking to all of the members, and then facilitate the process of helping the participants to create categories for the data, and rearranging it to gain new understandings.

MATERIALS:
These materials are needed in order to complete this method:

- Internet
- Gmail Account
- Computer
- Phone with conferencing abilities

Sensemaking for Waiting Situations

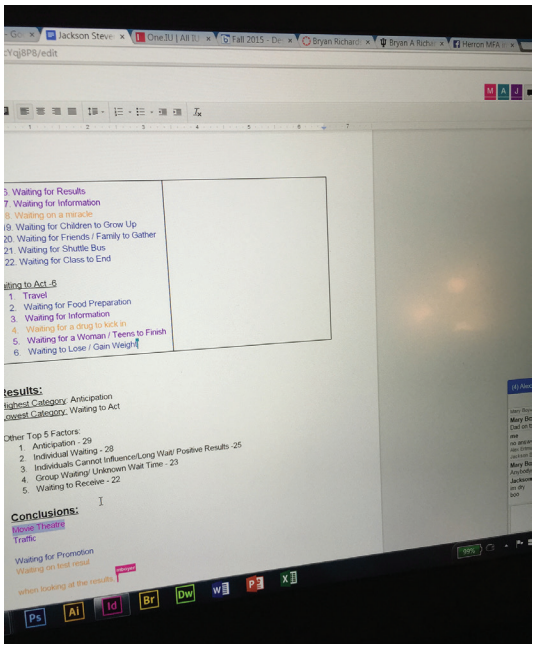
Known Wait Time-16	DMV
1. DMV	Airport
2. Travel	Doctor Waiting Room / Dentist
3. Waiting for new season of tv	Social Security Office
4. Waiting for Food Preparation	Theme Park Ride Lines
5. Waiting for Information	Food Service
6. Shopping	Banks
7. Airport	Checkout
8. Waiting for Christmas / Holiday / Birthday	Movie Theatre
9. Traffic	Travel
10. Waiting on test results	Waiting for Patient Info
11. Waiting for Package	Waiting for Information
12. Waiting for Friends / Family to Gather	Waiting for Package
13. Checkout	Waiting for Results
14. Movie Theatre	Waiting for a Woman / Teens to Finish Shopping
15. Waiting for Shuttle Bus	Waiting for Technology
16. Waiting for Class to End	Waiting for Christmas / Holiday / Birthday
Unknown Wait TIme-23	Traffic
1. Waiting for Seasons to Change	Waiting for Food Preparation
2. Travel	Waiting for Children to Grow Up
3. Food Service	Waiting for Friends / Family to Gather
4. Banks	Waiting for Shuttle Bus
5. Waiting for a Woman / Teens to Finish	Waiting for Class to End
6. Waiting for Promotion	Waiting to Lose / Gain Weight
7. Theme Park Ride Lines	Waiting for Seasons to Change
8. Shopping	Waiting for Promotion
9. Doctor Waiting Room / Dentist	Waiting on someone to return from war
10. Airport	Waiting on test results
11. Waiting for Results	Waiting on a miracle
12. DMV	Waiting on an e-mail
13. Waiting on someone to return from war	Waiting for a drug to kick in
14. Waiting for Patient Info	Waiting for new season of tv
15. Waiting for Food Preparation	Waiting to turn 16/18/21
16. Waiting for Information	
17. Waiting on test results	
18. Waiting on a miracle	
19. Waiting for Children to Grow Up	
20. Waiting for Friends / Family to Gather	
21. Waiting for Shuttle Bus	
22. Waiting for Class to End	
23. Waiting to Lose / Gain Weight	

BENEFITS:

This method is flexible with the team's availability and location. Participants don't need to be in the same room to conduct this method, which is beneficial in today's society.

CHALLENGES:

The challenges with this method are also it's benefits: technology and participants being divided. Sometimes this can make it harder to communicate. To avoid this the Google Doc should be well organized and all participants should be informed prior to about the objective, process, and guidelines for sensemaking.



GROUPING OF PHYSICAL OBJECTS

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
The objective of this method is to gain a better understanding of "data" by physically moving items into categories in a space.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Observe the objects in their current state and current categories if any
2. Remove the objects and group the contents based on their current placement
3. Find patterns in the objects and re-categorize the objects by moving them around the space
4. Place the new groups back into the space to view

MATERIALS:
The materials needed would depend on your "data" and if they consist of any physical objects. For example, the materials when applied to a kitchen pantry would include: food supplies, cabinets/shelves in pantry, and paper to record categories.

BENEFITS:
The primary benefit of this method is being able to visually and physically move your data, and you are able to more clearly see all of the contents. This could allow you to discover new things that were always there, but previously not noticed.

CHALLENGES:
The success of this method really depends on the objective of what you are trying to understand and the type of "data" you have and if it can be moved and held, or if it can be converted to be represented by physical objects. This probably wouldn't work with an excessive amount of data.

DATA VISUALIZATION

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

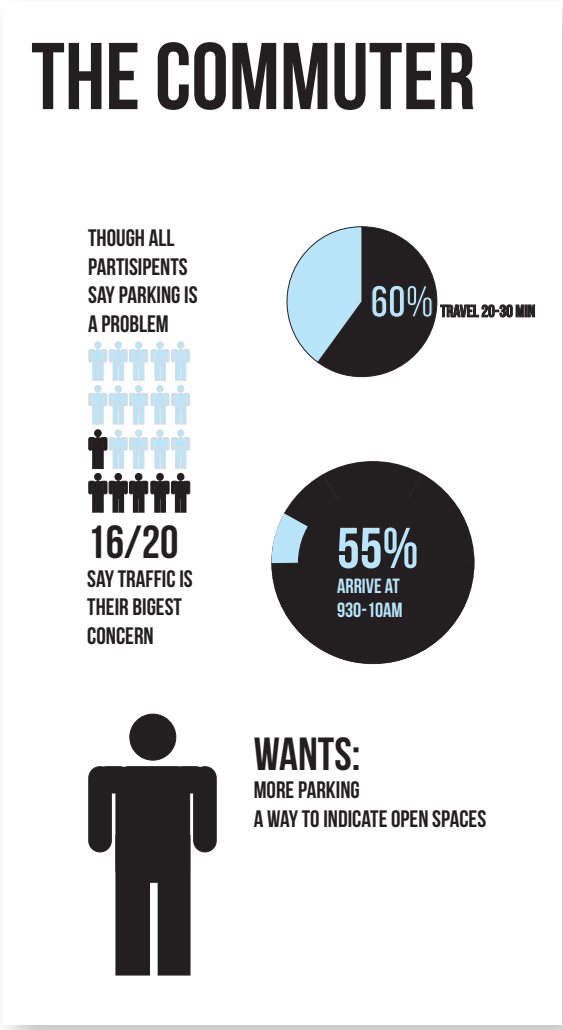
MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Subject / Not Present

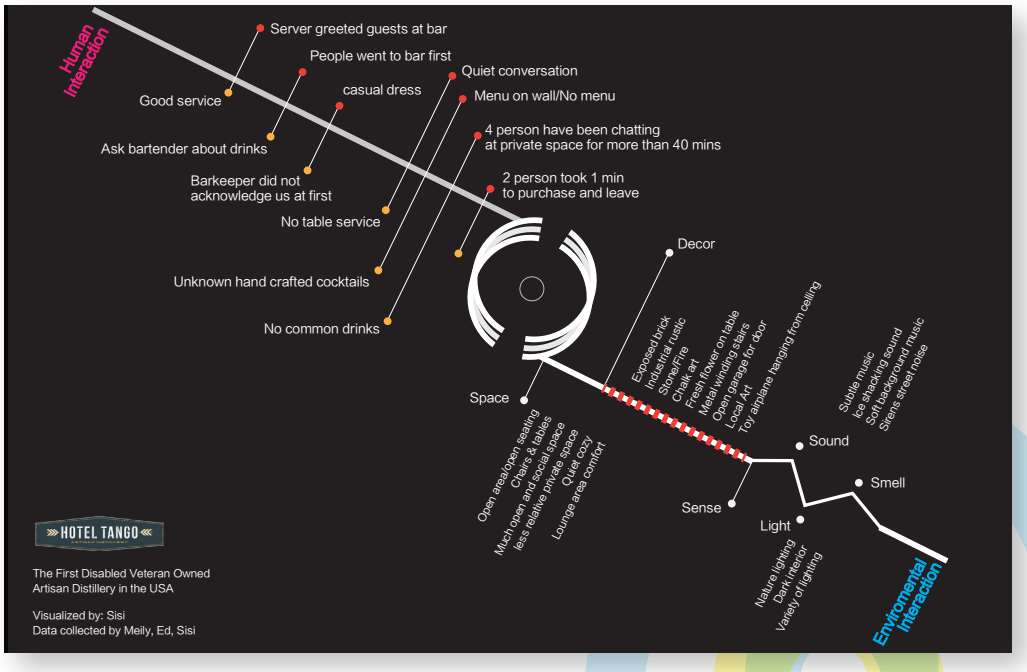
OBJECTIVE:
A primary goal of data visualization is to communicate information clearly and efficiently to users via the statistical graphics, plots, information graphics, tables, and charts selected. Effective visualization helps users in analyzing and reasoning about data and evidence. It makes complex data more accessible, understandable and usable.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Gather complex quantitative and qualitative data through an Exploratory method.
2. Categorize the data and establish affinity.
3. Visualize the data by using graphic design knowledge.

MATERIALS:
Construction of a data visualization is much like creating other printed or digital products. The main materials are pen and paper and a graphic program.





BENEFITS:

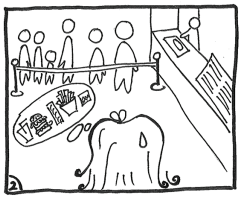
Information was able to be understood and communicated in a visually interesting manner that communicates the value of the data collected.

CHALLENGES:

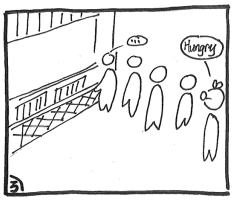
Understanding how to represent relevant data that relates to the audience and conveying the meaning of the data.

STORYBOARDING

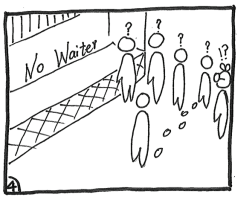
I am very hungry. I am going to campus center food court. Time is noon time, 12:05. I guess there have many people waiting for food.



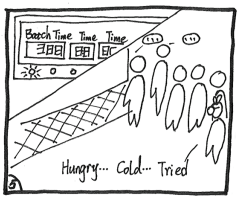
Great! Don't have many people. Let me think what to eat for lunch.
More and more students coming...



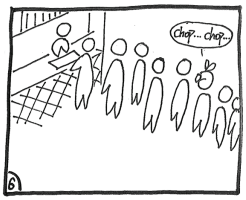
Oh, no! I should quickly.
This line people at least. No matter what to eat.



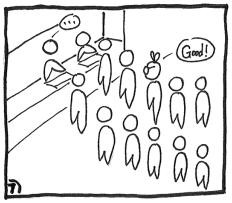
Waiting for food.
Last 2 mimutes.
Oh, xxx! A boy jump the queue.



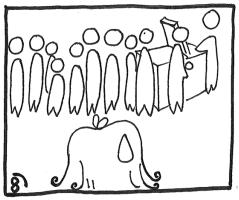
After 5 minutes...
Waiting... Crying...
Select the wrong line! Waiting for fried chicken.



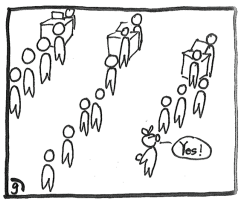
Waiting for making burgers.
So hungry!



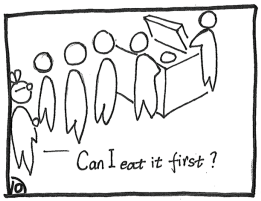
Two waiters. 30 seconds. Done! More and more students....



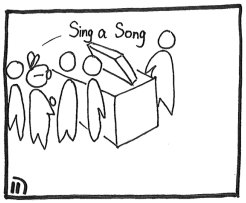
Waiting for check out.
Kill me, please!



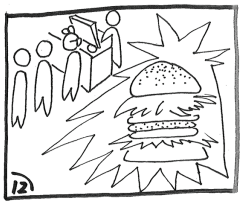
Select the shortest line.



Really want to eat it first! It smells good.
Look around...Nobody eating before check out.
But! Nobody tell me I can not eat first.



Forget it... It is very fast to check out.
Quickly! Quickly!.....



DONE!

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
Capture and understand underlying elements of your design challenge.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Take notes about space, events, feelings and thoughts during the immersion experience.
2. Take photos.
3. After gathering the data, create a storyboard for others to understand the design challenge.

MATERIALS:

- Pen and paper
- Camara

BENEFITS:
Creating the storyboard allows for easier understanding of the experience. It provides data that can later be compiled into a Journey Map.

CHALLENGES:

1. Large amounts of data are hard to analyze. It is difficult to distinguish was to focus on.
2. Making sure that illustrations really depict the situation you want to communicate.

VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS

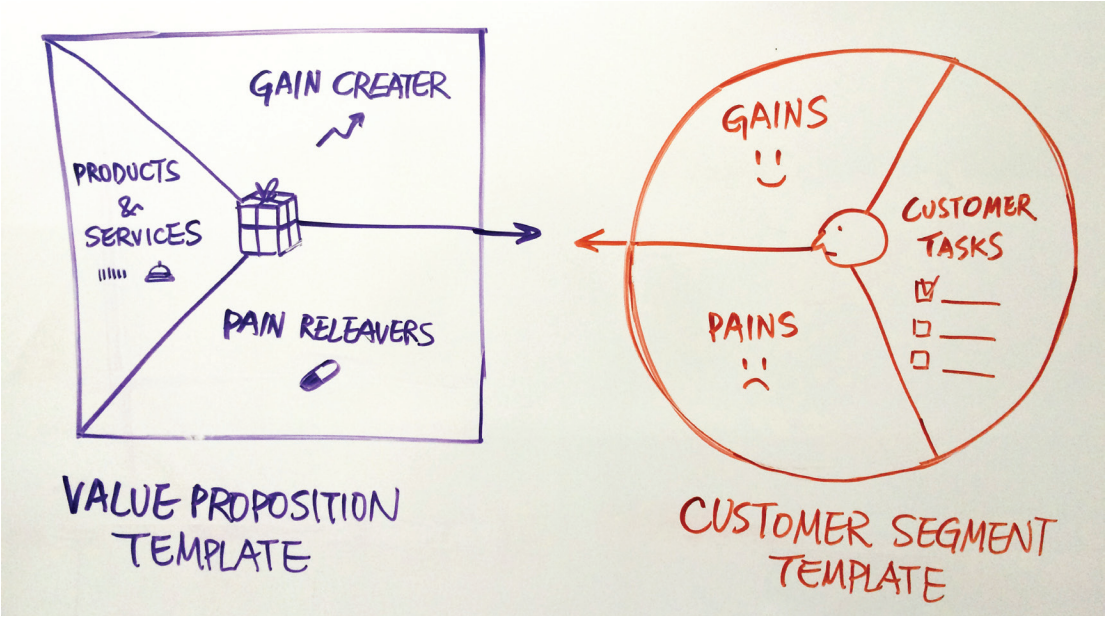
MODE OF INQUIRY:
Sensemaking

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
To analyze explicit features of users and develop value propositions.

MATERIALS:
- Post-its
- Markers
- Whiteboard with Canvas templates
- Question prompts

ACTIVITIES:
1. Draw two canvas on the whiteboard with a value proposition template and a customer segment template.
2. Ask participant to illustrate the customer's features on the post-it note according to the prompt and place the post-it notes on the customer segment template.
3. Group and prioritize the top three to five features in each segment and remove the rest of the features
4. Fill out the value proposition according to the customer segment template.



BENEFITS:
To clearly define what value the intended solution will create for users.

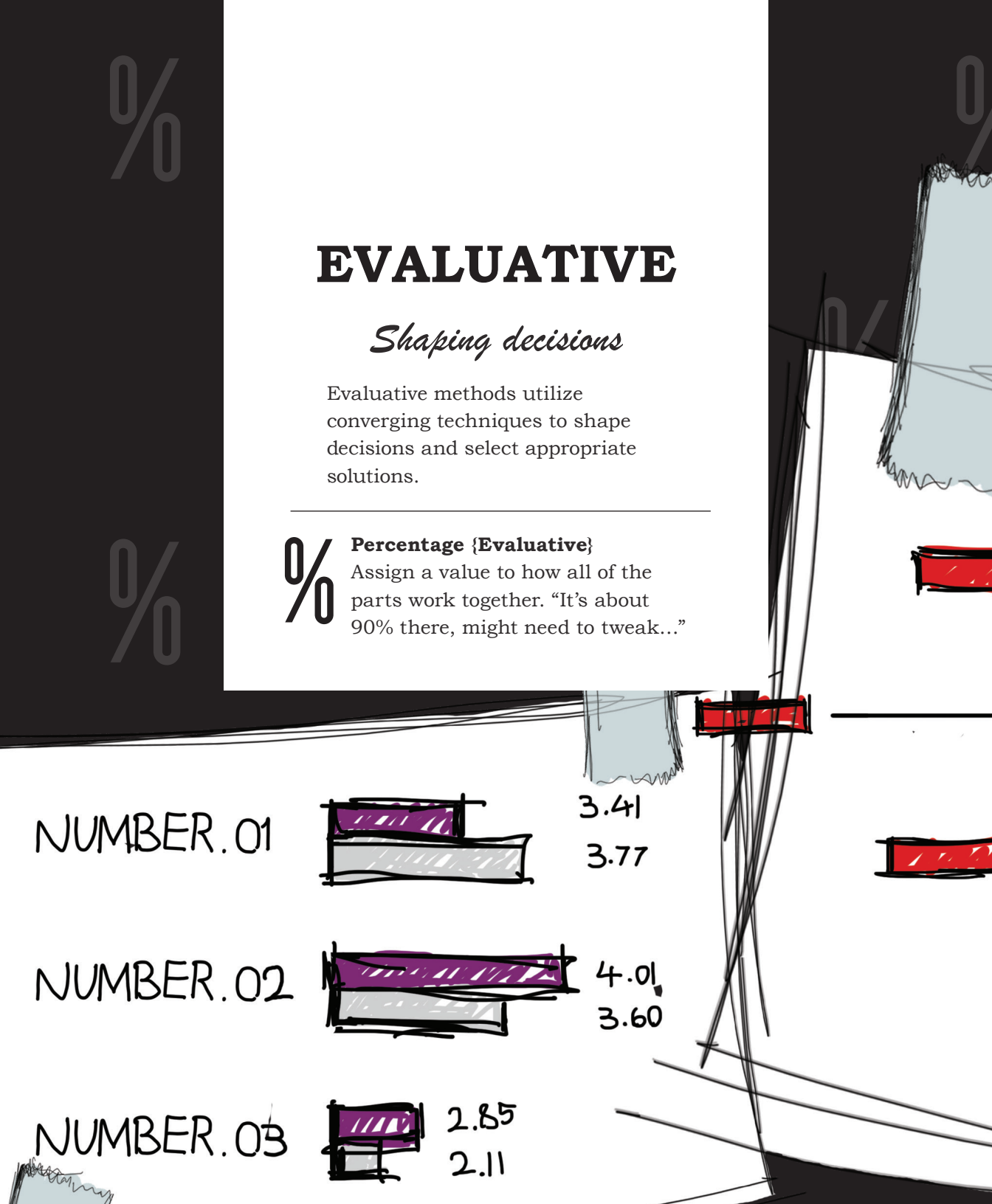
CHALLENGES:
The input of the customer segment requires participants' understanding of the user.

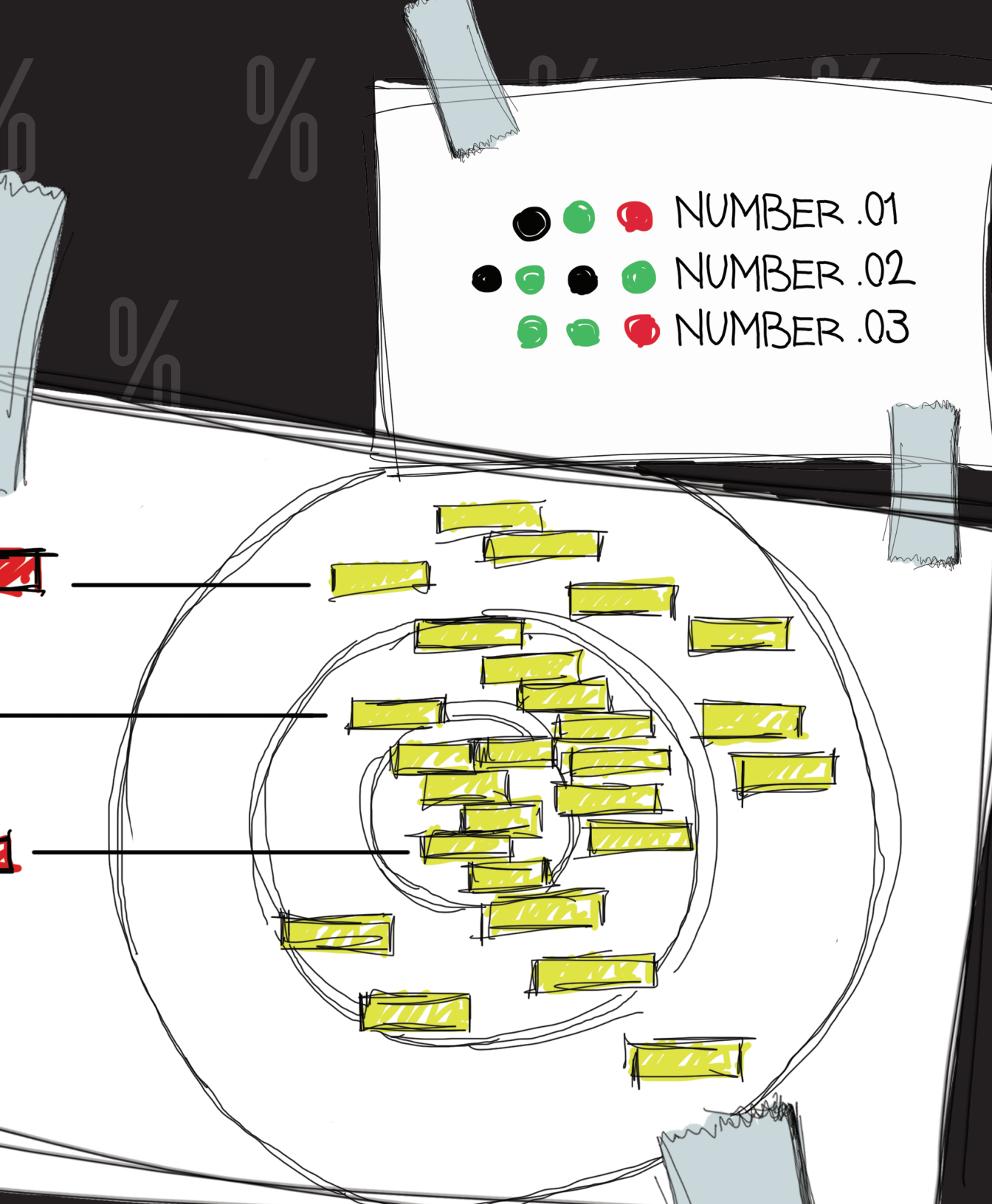
EVALUATIVE

Shaping decisions

Evaluative methods utilize converging techniques to shape decisions and select appropriate solutions.

Percentage {Evaluative}
Assign a value to how all of the parts work together. “It’s about 90% there, might need to tweak...”




NUMBER .01
NUMBER .02
NUMBER .03

BULLSEYE DIAGRAM

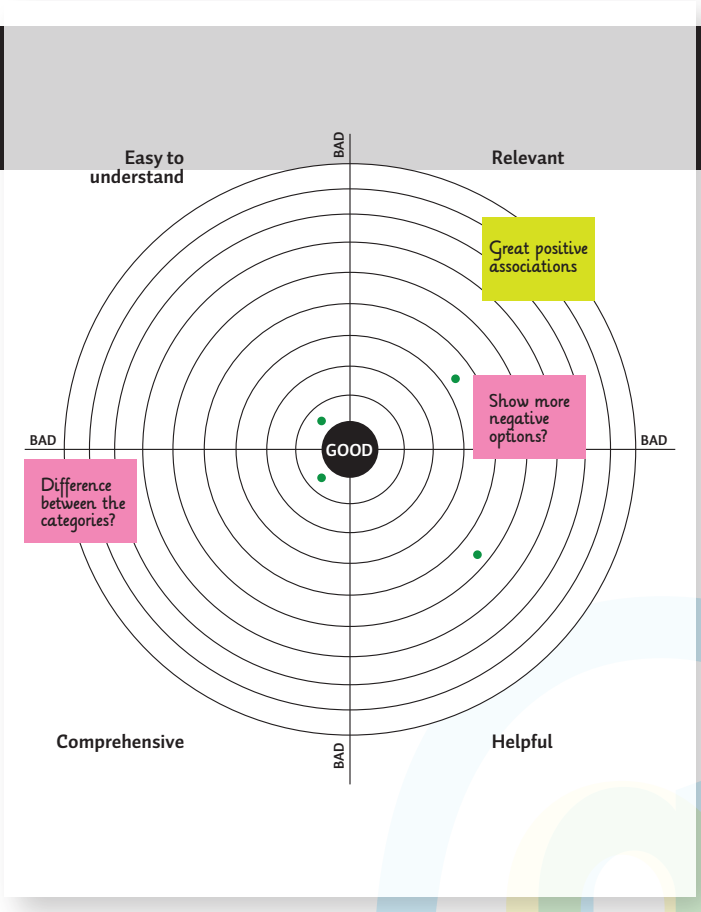
MODE OF INQUIRY:
Evaluative

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
The bullseye diagram is a great way to evaluate a product or service using the visual scale provided by the diagram. The closer the mark is made to the center of the diagram, the better the evaluation; the further out, the weaker the evaluation. The grid is divided into 4 quadrants evaluating different aspects of the product or service. The visual layout of the diagram helps give a quick and insightful overview of the quality of the product or service and opportunity areas for improving. Sticky notes may help the evaluator hint at what could be worked out with more explicit explanations or notes.

ACTIVITIES:
1. The participant is given time to use and evaluate the product or service.
2. After that, they are handed the diagram and are asked to mark in each of the 4 quadrants where they think the product lies.
3. If the participant finds that there could be specific areas of improvement in each of the four quadrants, it is possible to add in comments using sticky notes in the specific quadrant.

MATERIALS:
- Bullseye Diagram
- Blank Sticky Notes
- Marker
- Original results/product/data to evaluate



BENEFITS:

Allows users ability to evaluate product or service without much influence or intervention from the evaluation administrator.

CHALLENGES:

1. Establishing clear evaluation criteria that was comprehensive enough to evaluate the particular product or service.
2. Making sure the evaluator understands the categories.

% SURVEY

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Evaluative

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

OBJECTIVE:
Collect information from people based upon their personal opinions and experience. By providing a specific criteria, participants can answer guided questions to gain insight in a focused area. Usually helpful with a large sample of people.

ACTIVITIES:
Develop a set of criteria that allows you to appropriately evaluate your participants. Organize that criteria in a creative way that allows for an appropriate evaluation. Decide the type of survey by selecting criteria that will be opened-ended, comparative, or numerical.

MATERIALS:
- Structured questionnaire
- Incentives for participants
- Clear visual of what is being evaluated

BENEFITS:

1. Get instant feedback on area of research.
2. Gain insight from the users.
3. Rank the values among participants.

CHALLENGES:

Developing the most appropriate criteria can be challenging. Ask yourself what information do you need to know in order to make this subject successful?

VIRTUAL CRITERIA TABLE

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Evaluative

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Not Present

OBJECTIVE:
This method can be used when needing to evaluate a short list of ideas or solutions for a given challenge.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Connect to the Google Doc and to a Phone Conference
2. Choose the top 5 ideas to discuss and evaluate
3. Create a criteria table and scale based on the parameters of the challenge (some criteria may be weighted more than others)
4. Discuss individual options against the criteria and collectively decide on the scores as a group
5. Evaluate the total scores and decide on a challenge that best meets the criteria of the challenge.

Tip

MATERIALS:

- Data
- Computer
- Internet
- Gmail account
- Telephone

BENEFITS:
Participants for this method do not need to be present and can interact virtually. Discussing ideas over the phone and sharing a visual criteria table, participants can interact from various locations, and in the comfort of their own surroundings.

CHALLENGES:
The challenge here is that sometimes it can be hard to communicate via phone or via the Google Doc. Having a team of participants that has worked together previously is ideal and can help alleviate this.

% CRITERIA GRID

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Evaluative

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Present

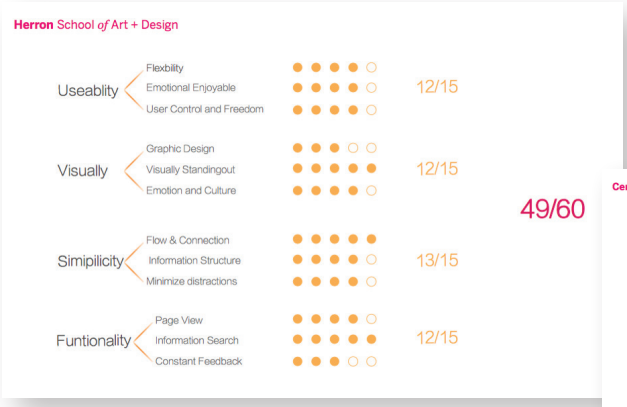
OBJECTIVE:
The criteria grid works well when you need to decide which of several options is the best choice for your group's purposes. You list the criteria for selection and then compare your options to the criteria. Your criteria are the main points you wish to use to make your best choice.

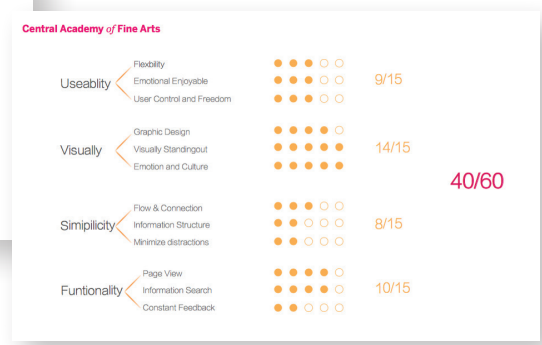
ACTIVITIES:

1. Identify your list of criteria.
2. Decide the scale and weight for each criteria.
3. Make a grid on a paper or white board, list the criteria across the top, and draw a vertical column under each. Make a total column along the right-hand edge of the grid. List the options down the left-hand side and create a horizontal row beside each.
4. Take one option at a time and compare it to each criterion.
5. Calculate the total score.

MATERIALS:

- Paper or whiteboard
- Pen & marker





BENEFITS:
The benefit of this method is that researchers can clearly see the advantages and disadvantages of each option. This method also allows researchers to have a comprehensive evaluation.

CHALLENGES:
The challenge here is that sometimes it is hard for team to decide criteria, scale and weight.

CATEGORICAL EVALUATION

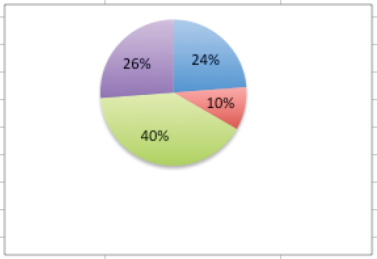
MODE OF INQUIRY:
Evaluative

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Not Present

OBJECTIVE:
A categorical evaluative scale has the ability to quantify the positive and negative aspects of a concept. Through multiple evaluations a common pattern of qualities will surface to understand people's perceptions. Depending on the desired objective, the criteria can be developed by the participating evaluator or the researcher.

ACTIVITIES:
The main activities of categorical evaluations involve deciding on a scale and selecting categories to evaluate. The selection of these two parts can be done by the participant and by those conducting the study. These depend on how you want to engage with those filling out the evaluation sheet.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1		learning by watching	learning by listening	learning by doing it	learning by feeling			
2	color selection	2	0	1	0			
3	layout arrangement	2	0	2	1			
4	tool usage	0	1	2	0			
5	drawing object	0	0	2	1			
6	theme deciding	2	1	2	2			
7	draft the idea	0	0	0	0			
8	space porpotion	2	1	2	2			
9	balance	2	1	2	1			
10	process preparation	0	0	2	2			
11	being focus	0	0	2	2			
12	drawing skills	0	1	2	2			
13	SUM	10	4	17	11	42		
14	Percentage	24%	10%	40%	26%			
15								
16	Participant Profile:	Have self-learned painting for one month						
17		Have done 9 paintings during self-learning					2	Strongly agree
18		None painting-tranining before					1	Agree
19		8:30am-6:30pm white collar working professiona					0	Disagree
20		Personal quote "Painting is my exploration to another cretive part of psyche (contiousness)"						
21		35 to 40 years old						
22		Male						



MATERIALS:

1. Excel or Word document
2. Print out of evaluation matrix
3. Pen

BENEFITS:

Understanding the strengths of a concept or object, based on categories derived from the qualities derived from the concept to be evaluated. It allows you to see a clearly synthesized result.

CHALLENGES:

The scale can be arbitrary as people grade subjectively and the use of some portions of the scale may not be used. This test is best used in quantity if you want an understanding of the selected criteria. One can also miss criteria they wish was evaluated in the Matrix.

ELECTRONIC VOTING

MODE OF INQUIRY:
Evaluative

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:
Participant / Not Present

OBJECTIVE:
Helps select a solution among multiple participants in a quick and efficient manner.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Ask paticipants to select criteria by interviewing
2. Pose criteria onto message board
3. Have participants vote on most preferred criteria to narrow findings

MATERIALS:

- Internet connection
- Social Chat APP such as Telegram
- Paper and Pen for us to take notes from their words, and catagorize the information.

BENEFITS:
Get solutions quickly and efficiently while making it convenient for participants.

CHALLENGES:
Communicating electronically while convenient, can be difficult to coordinate everyone's input.

MODE OF INQUIRY:

MODE OF ENGAGEMENT:

OBJECTIVE:

ACTIVITIES:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

MATERIALS:

-
-
-
-

BENEFITS:

1.

2.

3.

4.

CHALLENGES:

Any new methods come to mind while reading these? Create your own!